

National Exam of Higher National Diploma 2024 Session

Specialty/option : All Specialties
Paper : ENGLISH
Duration : 2 Hours

Credit : 1

INSTRUCTIONS: Answer all questions and in good English respecting the order in which they have been set.

SECTION A: READING COMPREHENSION (20mks)

Read the passage below and answer the questions that follow

Ministers, and the people that have been under their care, must be parted in this world, no matter how well they have been united. If they are not separated before, they must be parted by death, and they may be separated while life is continued. We live in a world of change, where nothing is certain or stable, and where a little time, a few revolutions of the sun, brings to pass strange things and surprising alterations in particular persons, families, towns, churches, countries, and nations.

It often happens that those who seem most united are, in a little time, most disunited, and at the greatest distance. Thus ministers and people, between whom there has been the greatest mutual regard and strictest union, may not only differ in their judgments and be alienated in affection, but one may rend from the other and all relation between them be dissolved. The minister may be removed to a distant place, and they may never have any more to do one with another in this world. But if it be so, there is one meeting more that they must have, and that is in the last great day of accounts.

Since I have been settled in the work of the ministry in this place, I have always had a peculiar concern for the souls of the young people, and a desire that religion might flourish among them. Because I knew the special opportunity they had beyond others and that ordinarily those for whom

God intended mercy were brought to fear and love him in their youth. And it has ever appeared to me a peculiarly amiable thing to see young people walking in the ways of virtue and Christian piety, having their hearts purified and sweetened with a principle of divine love. How exceedingly beautiful and conducive to the adorning and happiness of the town if the young people could be persuaded, when they meet together, to converse as Christians and as the children of God, avoiding impurity, levity, and extravagance, keeping strictly to rules of virtue and conversing together of the things of God and Christ and heaven!

This is what I have longed for, and it has been exceedingly grievous to me when I have heard of vice, vanity, and disorder among our youth. And so far as I know my own heart, it was from hence that I formerly led this church to some measures, for the suppressing of vice among our young people, which gave so great offense, and by which I became so obnoxious. I have sought the good and not the hurt of our young people. I have desired their truest honor and happiness, and not their reproach: knowing that true virtue and religion tended not only to the glory and felicity of young people in another world, but their greatest peace and prosperity and highest dignity and honor in this world, and above all things to sweeten, and render pleasant and delightful, even the days of youth. But whether I have loved you, and sought your good more or less, now committing your souls to him who once committed the pastoral care of them to me—nothing remains, but only (as I am now taking my leave of you) earnestly to beseech you, from love to yourselves, if you have none to me, not to despise and forget the warnings and counsels I have so often given you. Remember the day when you and I must meet again before the great Judge of quick and dead, when it will appear whether the things I have taught you were true, whether the counsels I have given you were good, whether I truly sought your welfare, and whether you have well improved my endeavors. I have, from time to time, earnestly warned you against some liberties commonly taken by young people in the land. And whatever some may say in justification of such liberties and customs, and may laugh at warnings against them, I now leave you my parting testimony against such things, not doubting but God will approve and confirm it in that day when we shall meet before him.

QUESTIONS (20marks)

1. Based on the passage, how does the author likely feel about leaving his post? (2marks)

- A) Melancholic and reflective
- B) Angry and resentful
- C) Relieved and content
- D) Gleeful and giddy

2. In Paragraph 2, Sentence 2, the word "strictest" most closely means (2marks)

- A) sternest.
- B) harshest.
- C) closest.
- D) narrowest.

3. Over the course of the passage, the author expresses a particular concern for (2marks)

- A) ministers who no longer have congregations.
- B) young people in the church.
- C) orphans and widows.
- D) souls that are facing judgment.

4. Which lines in the passage best support the answer to the previous question? (2marks)

- A) Paragraph 1, Sentence 1 ("Ministers . . . united")
- B) Paragraph 2, Sentence 3 ("The minister . . . world")
- C) Paragraph 3, Sentence 1 ("Since I . . . them")
- D) Paragraph 5, Sentence 1 ("But whether . . . you")

5. According to the passage, what is the author's observation about young people's compliance with divine law? (2marks)

- A) They sometimes but not always adhere to its standards
- B) They are less likely than both children and adults to comply
- C) They mock all who try to adhere to its standards of behaviour
- D) They are eager to please and afraid to disappoint

6. The author implies in the fourth paragraph that he (2marks)
- A) used to fall prey to both vice and vanity in his youth before turning to religion.
 - B) failed to institute the strict standards of behavior necessary to properly instruct the church's youth.
 - C) wishes he could go back to his own youth in order to seek prosperity and happiness.
 - D) may have been removed from his post because of overzealous care and policing of young people in his community.
7. The author indicates that he believes that one day the "great Judge" will (2marks)
- A) condemn him and all other sinners.
 - B) confirm the wisdom of the author's counsel.
 - C) pardon all souls who defied his laws.
 - D) testify against the author's wayward congregation.
8. The passage can primarily be classified as which of the following? (2marks)
- A) A direct threat
 - B) An offering of advice
 - C) A circular argument
 - D) A personal anecdote
9. Give a suitable title to the passage (4marks)

SECTION B: GRAMMAR & VOCABULARY (30marks)

GRAMMAR (20 marks)

With a question tag, invite a confirmation of the following observations (3 marks)

1. Even in the age of electronic mails, letters still got posted-----? (1mark)
2. They would still have to be posted for a long while yet-----? (1mark)
3. The boss sacked all his employees.....? (1mark)

Fill in the blanks with the correct forms of the verbs in brackets (2marks)

4. I am tired. We (walk) for over an hour. Lets stop and rest for a while. (0.5mark)
5. I..... just(turn off) the lights when the telephone.....(ring) (1.5marks)

Turn the Sentences as demanded at the end or as started for you (5marks)

6. The careless businessman squanders all his money on unnecessary things (passive voice). (1mark)
7. " Did you send him your letter of apology yesterday?", the man asked. (Indirect speech) (1mark)
8. The money could not yield any interest because it was deposited in the current account. (2marks)

If this money wasn't deposited in the current account.....

9. She advised me to follow him (Passive voice)
10. 10. John is (bad) ----- than Peter at Maths (comparative). (1mark)

Complete the sentences below with the correct verb. (10marks)

The dead trees and peeling paint, along with the broken windows and

1. flapping shutters, _____ everyone believe that evil spirits haunt the deserted Sinclair house. (2marks)
 - A. made
 - B. has made
 - C. makes
 - D. make
2. Where _____ the earrings that I left by the bathroom sink? Oh no! That stupid cat has swatted them down the drain again! (1mark)
 - A. was
 - B. were

- C. is
D. are
3. Neither of those sharks circling your boogie board _____ hungry enough to bite.
(1mark)
B. looks
C. look
D. looked
E. had looked
4. One hundred and fifty gallons _____ the amount of liquid the average living room rug can absorb. Rachel discovered this fact after taking a long shower when the curtain wasn't tucked inside the tub. (1mark)
A. is
B. are
C. was
D. were
5. Agnes never loses a single possession. Everyone knows what belongs to her, for each pen, pencil, and paperclip _____ a tiny flag attached with Agnes' full name on it. (1mark)
A. will have
B. has
C. have
D. had
6. Asteroids and comets slamming into Earth _____ Marge; she tries to remain under the protective cover of her roof as much as possible. (1mark)
A. worries
B. worry
C. worried
D. used to worry
7. Someone—perhaps Emmanuel or Paul—_____ the right wine to serve with earthworm lasagna. (1mark)
A. knew
B. will know

C. knows

D. know

8. These scissors _____ so dull that I'm not sure you could slice butter with them! (1mark)

A. is

B. are

C. has been

D. had been

9. Physics _____ proven to be Jerry's easiest subject this semester. He brings Carol, the lab assistant, an oatmeal-raisin cookie, and, as his reward, she finishes his report. (1mark)

A. has

B. have

C. had

D. will have

VOCABULARY (10 marks)

1. Briefly explain what each of the following proverbs and idioms meaning (5 Marks)

a. Add insult to injury.----- (1mark)

b. Cost an arm and a leg.----- (1mark)

c. A picture paints a thousand words.----- (1mark)

d. Once in a blue moon .----- (1mark)

e. Let the cat out of the bag.----- (1mark)

2. For each word find another which is pronounced similarly but which is spelt differently and has a different meaning. (5 Marks)

a. Pear----- (1mark)

b. Still----- (1mark)

c. Male----- (1mark)

d. Feel----- (1mark)

e. Rice----- (1mark)

SECTION C: SPOKEN ENGLISH (20 marks)

I. Identify the word with an odd sound in each group and write in the space provided (5marks)

- 1- Bark , bake, back, dam.....(1mark)
- 2- Sea , see, seak, set(1mark)
- 3- Meai , meat ,lead , met.....(1mark)
- 4- Tall, tail, tale take.....(1mark)
- 5- Lack , lake, sad, black.....(1mark)

II. Transcribe the following words in the space provided (5marks)

- 1- Sail.....(1mark)
- 2- Waist.....(1mark)
- 3- Car.....(1mark)
- 4- Boy.....(1mark)
- 5- We.....(1mark)

III. Put the stress mark on each word (5marks)

- 1- Export (1mark)
- 2- Danger (1mark)
- 3- Popular (1mark)
- 4- Water (1mark)
- 5- Manage (1mark)

IV. Write down the number of syllables in word in the space provided (5marks)

- 1- Generously(1mark)
- 2- Appreciation.....(1mark)
- 3- Informal.....(1mark)
- 4- Challenges.....(1mark)
- 5- Intelligently(1mark)

SECTION D : COMPOSITION (30marks)

A. Write a composition of not more than 450 to 500 words on one of the following

1. I must make a change
2. Write a letter to a carpeting company about defective carpeting. Pay attention to correct spelling, paragraphing, punctuation and the essentials of business writing. Orderly presentation of your work and standard English will be an advantage. Your address:
Bolevard Hotel, Britain, Bonia street 214.
3. My first day in the University